

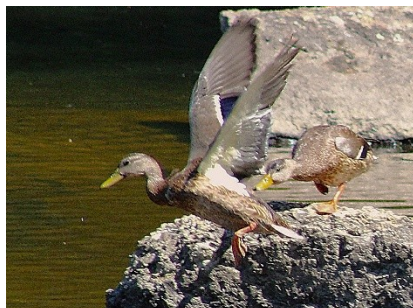
September 3, 2026 ***“Procrastinate now, don’t put it off.”*** - Lily Tomlin

Wayne Dyer observed that the paradox of life is that we are doomed to make choices. I suppose so; the freedom to make choices sounds like quite a blessing, but it can feel like such a heavy and unfair burden sometimes. Not deciding, procrastinating, letting someone else choose for you, letting the clock run out...these are all choices too. Maybe it's picking a college or major, deciding which career opportunity to pursue, making a commitment that seems to foreclose other options, how and when to make decisions for others who are no longer (or not yet) able to choose for themselves. And it's not always a struggle we feel that is left to us unfettered. We are prodded, pulled, pressured, and nudged from behind, making it feel like it's not really our decision at all. We can respond to the pressures by diving in or by digging in. "It's my life, so get off my back. But first, tell me what I should do." Sooner or later, we have no choice- we are doomed to make choices. Free will exacts its fee.

Happily, I'm not stuck right now facing any particularly hard choices but I know how quickly and frequently that can change and will change. I'm doomed to feel stuck again many times. We all are. All our choices (both the active and the passive ones) can lead to regrets; it's part of what makes them feel so hard. And it's natural enough to wonder what if.... What if I had gone to law school? What if I had moved to Boston? What if I'd spent more time being there? What if I'd been kinder, more patient, more loving? Regrets and wonder and imagining what might have been different "if only" are a part of life that follows all decisions. Resentment can be added to the review of our passive choices. After all, isn't that part of the calculus from the start? "If I don't decide for myself but default to you, it's not my fault how it turns out. It's your fault! Right? No? Oh? ...oh."

So now what?

.....Choose again, make better mistakes.



**Happy Thinksdays**